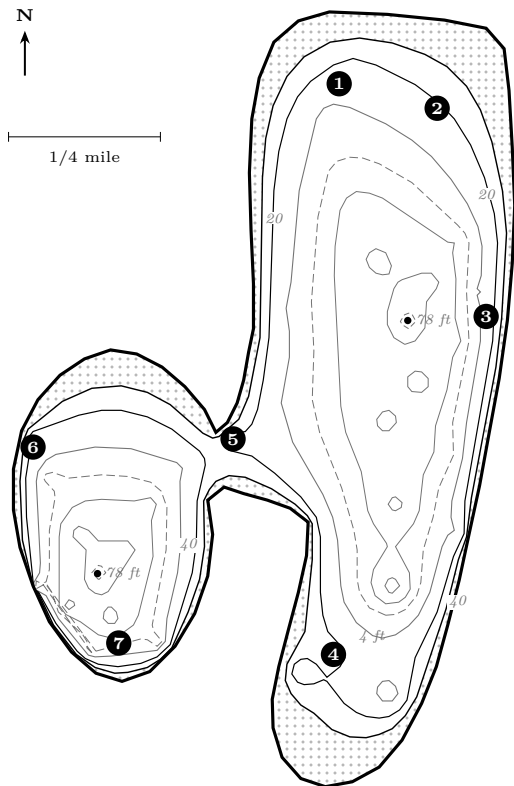


North Lake sits two miles north of Pine Lake and fishes almost nothing like it. It is a river lake: the Oconomowoc River enters the south-west lobe and leaves at the north-east corner, and that flow keeps the water stained where Pine Lake is glass. Lower clarity is an advantage. Fish here hold shallower, feed later into the morning, and are far less leader-shy. The lake is also two lakes — a long main basin and a round south-west lobe, each with its own deep hole near 78 ft, joined by one narrow neck that every fish in the system has to swim through.

Surface	440 acres (449 acres on the 1898 survey); 3.44 miles of shoreline
Depth	78.4 ft maximum. Two separate holes: one in each basin
Clarity	Low. Stained, river-fed water — shorter weed line, shallower fish, more forgiving of heavier line
Hydrology	Oconomowoc River in at the west end of the lobe, out at the north-east corner. Mud Lake lies immediately south
Fish	Panfish, largemouth bass, smallmouth bass and northern pike (all common), walleye (present)
Access	No municipal ramp. Carry-in public access in the Town of Merton; a DNR fishing pier and small-craft launch have been planned. Verify what exists and what it costs before you tow anything. Practically, this is a canoe, kayak or car-top lake



Depth in feet. Schematic — not for navigation. Redrawn from the Wisconsin Conservation Department lake survey sheet (data 1898, revised 21 October 1941; WBIC 850800), published by the Wisconsin DNR as a public document. Contours are reconstructed from that survey’s soundings and are generalized; a survey that old will not match a modern sonar log in detail.  under 5 ft  shoreline  5 & 10 ft  20 ft  30 ft  40 & 60 ft  70 ft  spot

The seven spots, by season

#	Spot	When & what	How
1	North-end flat	Apr–Jun panfish, largemouth, pike; Dec–Feb panfish under ice.	The broad shallow end of the main basin, under 30 ft nearly all the way across. Weed flats that warm first. Slip bobber at 4–10 ft; spinnerbait over the tops for pike.
2	North-east outlet corner	Apr–May and Sep–Nov pike and panfish.	Where the lake drains to the river. Moving water concentrates baitfish and the things that eat them. Fish the current seam. Quick-strike rig with a big sucker; jig-and-minnow on the edge.
3	East shoreline drop	Jun–Sep smallmouth and walleye; Oct pike.	The main basin’s east side falls off steadily to the 78 ft hole. Work the 15–30 ft band. Drop-shot, or a lindy rig dragged along the contour.
4	South-end shoal complex	May–Oct , everything.	Hard humps topping out near 4 ft with deep water all around — the best structure in the lake. Smallmouth and walleye stack on the edges; pike patrol the tops. Start shallow at dawn, work down to 20–25 ft by mid-morning.
5	The neck	All open water. Pike, bass, walleye, panfish.	The only connection between the two basins: a shallow, current-swept bottleneck. Everything that moves between basins passes through. Anchor off the edge and let bait sit; or cast a jig across and swing it with the current.
6	River inlet, west end of the lobe	Mar–May and Oct–Nov pike; panfish and bass in summer.	Incoming river water, warmest in spring and coldest in fall. Stained and weedy. Pike stage here before and after the spawn. Big bait, slow.
7	South shore of the lobe	Jun–Sep bass and panfish deep; Jul–Aug suspended fish.	A short, steep drop into the lobe’s own 78 ft hole. Fish the 12–25 ft break; in high summer look for fish suspended off the edge rather than on it.

How North Lake differs from Pine Lake

If you fish both, do not carry one lake’s habits to the other.

Fish shallower	Stained water means the weed line ends around 8–12 ft instead of 15–20 ft. The whole food chain moves up with it.
Fish later	Low-light advantage is smaller here. A cloudy mid-morning on North Lake can beat dawn.
Fish heavier	You can get away with heavier line, bigger baits and visible hardware. Save the fluorocarbon and the finesse for Pine.
Two lakes	Each basin has its own population behaviour. If the main basin is dead, cross the neck and fish the lobe — it is a different water.
The river matters	Spring warm-up, fall cool-down and after heavy rain, the inflow and outflow are the first places to look.
Getting there	No trailer ramp. That is why it stays quiet, and it is the best reason to fish it.

CHECK THE REGULATIONS BEFORE EVERY TRIP

The 2026–27 rules for this water are the same as Pine Lake’s: largemouth and smallmouth bass 14 in minimum, 5 per day, 2 May–7 March, catch-and-release the rest of the year; walleye 18 in minimum, 3 per day; northern pike 26 in minimum, 2 per day; muskellunge 40 in minimum, 1 per day, open water only through 31 December; panfish 25 per day; cisco and whitefish 10 per day. **These change.** The Wisconsin DNR publishes the current rules for this exact water body, and only that publication is authoritative.